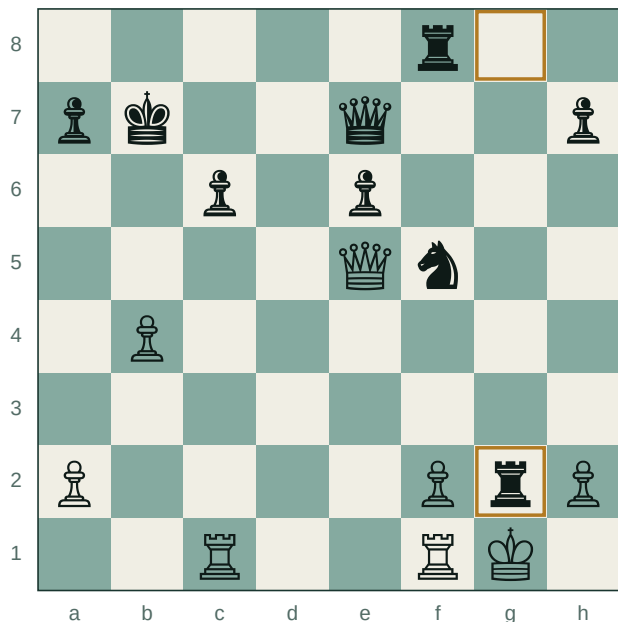


Active defensive resources: White, move 31

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 30...Rxf2+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. Kxg2 Nh4+ 32. Kh1

31.Kxg2 The king captures the rook on g2. Recorded reply: **31...Nh4+**.

32.Kh1 The king moves from g2 to h1.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on b7. Geometrically undefended: rook on g2. Check for tactical protection.